CYCLISTIC BIKE-SHARE: STRATEGIC ANALYSIS OF USER BEHAVIOR

CONVERTING CASUAL RIDERS TO ANNUAL MEMBERS

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Google Data Analytics Certificate
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THE CORE OBJECTIVE

- **Question:** How do annual members and casual riders use Cyclistic bikes differently?
- **Goal:** Identify trends to design a new marketing strategy for converting casual riders into long-term members.
- **Scope:** Analysis of **426,887 trips** from 2020 Q1 across Excel, R, and SQL.

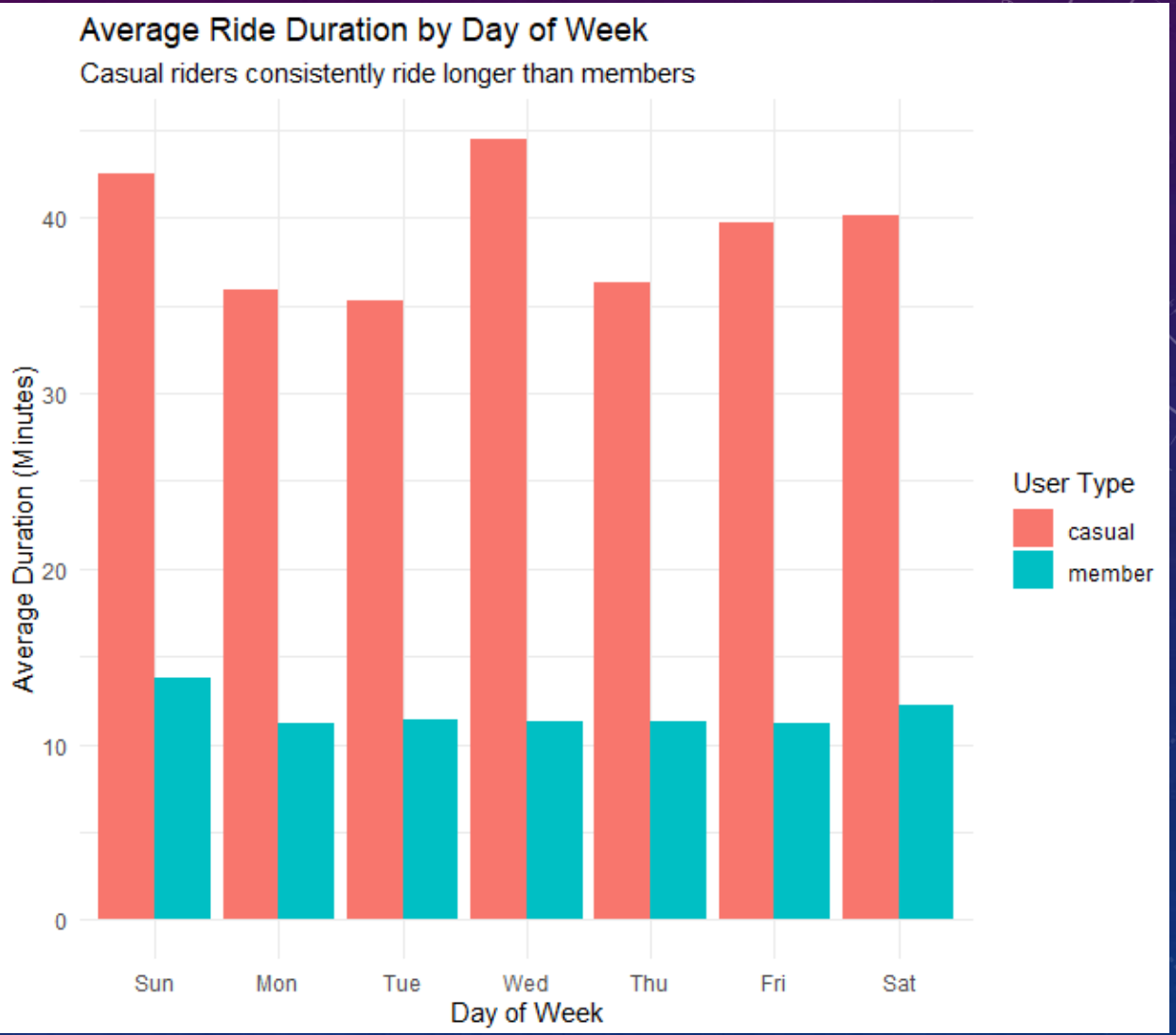
DATA INTEGRITY & VALIDATION

- **Tools Used:** Excel (initial cleaning), R (statistical analysis), and MySQL (data validation).
- **Cleaning Steps:** Removed trips <60 seconds, trips >24 hours, and administrative/test entries ("HQ QR").
- New Metrics: Calculated ride_length (duration) and day_of_week(usage patterns).

MEMBERS RIDE OFTEN, CASUALS RIDE LONG

Key Findings:

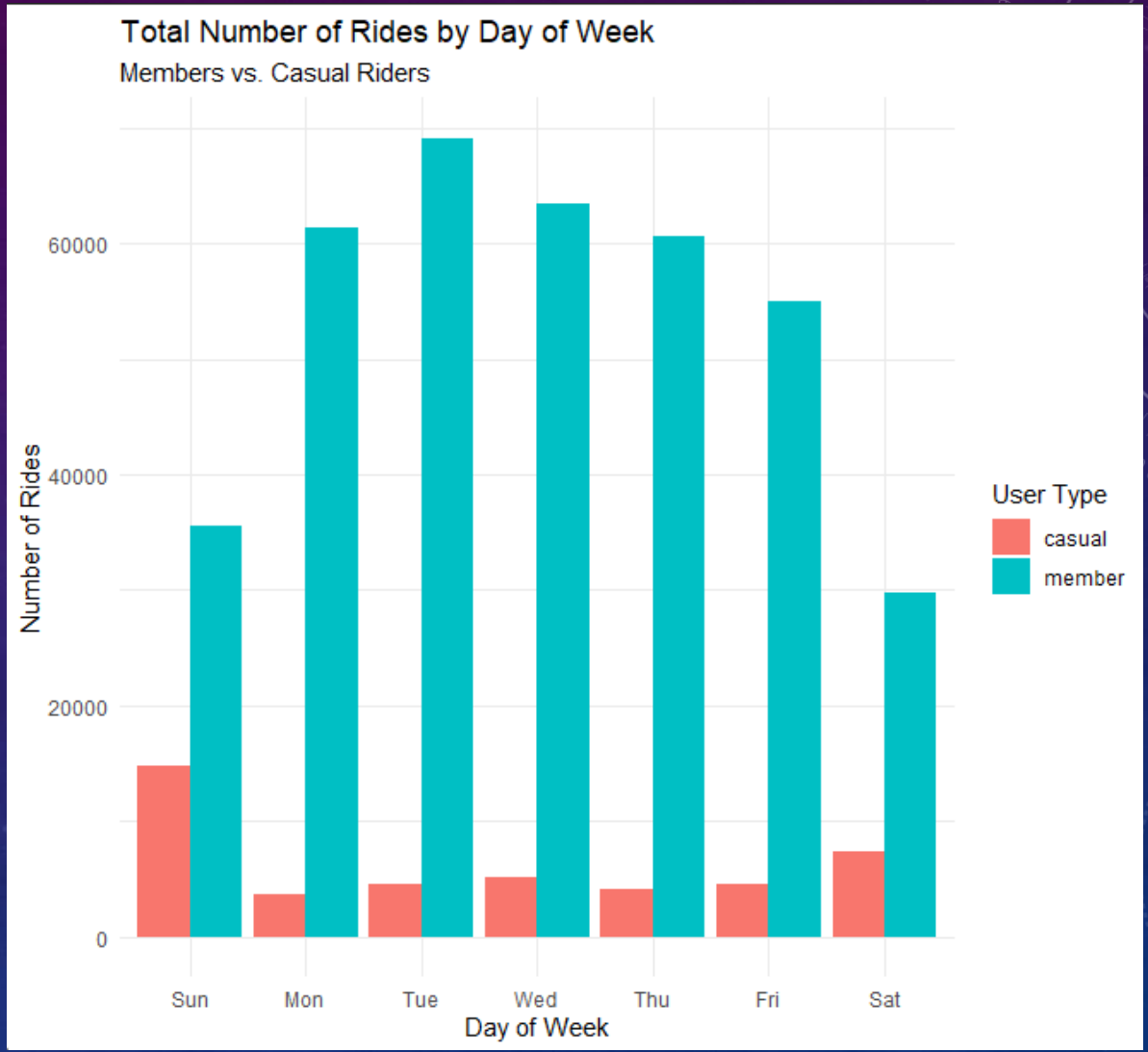
- **Casual Riders** average **≈40 minutes** per trip
- **Annual Members** average **≈ 12 minutes** per trip.
- Here we see that members use the service for point A to B utility (efficiency)
- Casual riders use it for experiences (leisure).



WEEKEND VS. WEEKDAY TRENDS

Key Findings:

- Members maintain steady, high-volume Monday–Friday (Commute peaks).
- Casual ridership spikes significantly on Saturday and Sunday.
- This confirms that Casual riders use Cyclistic primarily for weekend recreation.



PATH TO CONVERSION

- Recommendations:
  1. **Weekend-Only Membership:** Create a membership specifically for high-volume weekend users.
  2. **Seasonal Promotions:** Since casual durations are long, offer "Summer Passes" or "Spring Specials" when leisure riding is at its peak.
  3. **Digital Marketing:** Target advertisements at stations near parks and tourist attractions on Friday evenings.
- Data-driven strategies to turn weekend explorers into everyday members.

CONCLUSION:

Casual riders use Cyclistic for long-duration leisure activities, particularly on weekends, while Annual Members use it as a reliable, short-duration weekday commuting utility. To grow, Cyclistic must pivot from selling transportation to casuals and start selling convenient weekend access.

The Top Three Recommendations:

1. **Introduce a "Weekend Warrior" Membership:** Create a subscription tier that offers unlimited rides only on Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays. This specifically targets the peak usage times.
2. **Gamified Conversion Campaigns:** Use the app to send push notifications to Casual riders who exceed 30 minutes on a Saturday. Offer them a "Member for a Day" trial or a discount on an annual membership to show them the cost-savings of switching.
3. **Leisure-Zone Marketing:** Increase physical and digital advertising near parks, waterfronts, and tourist landmarks. Focus these ads on the benefits of Membership Perks which appeal to long-duration leisure riders.

THE END!!